



Comeback: After a dismal Paris Games, PV Sindhu won the Syed Modi International singles crown. GETTY IMAGES

then World No. 4 Anders Antonsen of Denmark to reach the semifinals of the Canada Open — one of the biggest wins in his young career.

Soon after the Olympics, teenager Tanvi Patri claimed the U-15 girls' singles title at the Badminton Asia U-17 & U-15 Junior Championships, becoming the third Indian to achieve the feat after Samiya Imad Farooqui and Tasnim Mir in 2017 and 2019, respectively.

Meanwhile, Malvika Bansod made waves at the China Open by upsetting Paris Olympics bronze medallist Gregoria Mariska Tunjung of Indonesia in her opening match.

However, her campaign ended in the quarterfinals against fourth seed Akane Yamaguchi of Japan.

Unhappy shuttlers

While there was plenty of high-octane action on the court, there was no shortage of drama off it. Numerous players — Indian and international, active and retired — voiced criticism against their respective national badminton federations.

Former Malaysian shuttler Lee Chong Wei issued a stern warning ahead of the Paris Olympics, calling for drastic changes to rescue the sport in his country.

He expressed deep frustration, admitting he felt like “giving up” on Malaysian badminton after the men's team suffered a 0–3 defeat to China

at the Asia Team Championships.

South Korea's An Se-Young, fresh off her Olympic gold triumph, criticised her federation for compelling her to compete despite injuries. She further lambasted the country's training methods, labelling them outdated.

Nitesh, shortly after his Paralympics gold win, openly expressed dissatisfaction with the Badminton Association of India (BAI). He called for Indian para-badminton to come under the governance of the Paralympic Committee of India (PCI). Towards the end of 2024, former Indian shuttler Parupalli Kashyap made a bold statement, claiming badminton in India had not grown significantly and that the sport merely revolved around its superstars and financial gains.